> PRIMUS · 20 NOVEMBER 2026 · 150 TEAMS · ONE NIGHT

Team guide

Everything your team needs for the night:
sign in, build, rescue, invest and win.

For every participant · read it before check-in

Build round · Rescue round · Invest round · AI judges · live market

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1. The night in one page

PRIMUS is a one-night business case competition. Your team of 3–4 plays **three rounds**. In each one you earn up to **100 points**, so the best possible total is **300**. AI judges score your written work, and those scores move share prices on a live market that every team trades in.

Round	What you do	Points
Round 1: Build	The lottery deals you a **problem card**. You name a company, claim a 4-letter ticker and write its **PRD** (product requirements document, up to 800 words).	Your PRD score (0–100)
The crisis	Every company is hit by a crisis and every share price falls 15%. A second lottery gives you **another team's company to rescue**. You question its founders on a public Q&A board.	–
Round 2: Rescue	You write a **crisis solution** (up to 500 words) for the company you rescue.	Your crisis-solution score (0–100)
Round 3: Invest	Every team gets **$100,000** of virtual money and trades shares in the other companies over nine trading rounds.	50 + 2.5 × your return % (0–100)

The planned timetable (IST). On the night the organisers start each phase and may move times. **Your screen always shows the real deadline**, so trust the countdown on your screen over this table.

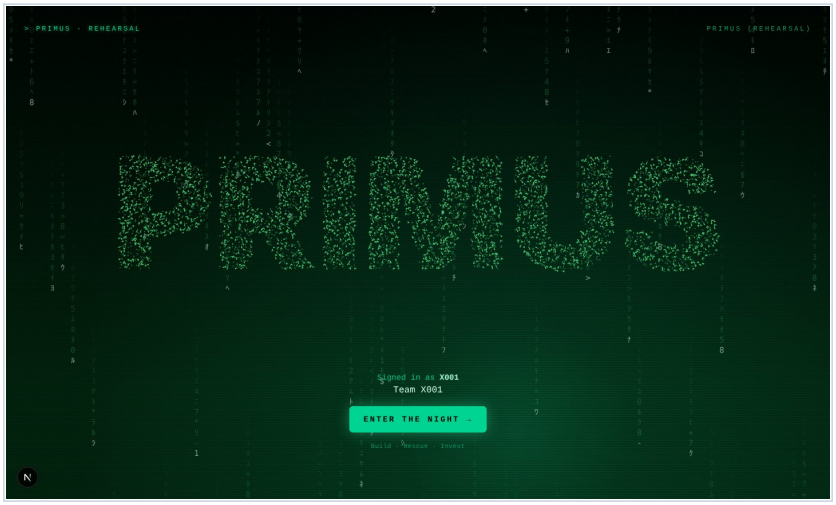
Planned	Phase	For your team
20:00	Check-in	Sign in with your card on every laptop and phone you will use.
20:45	Briefing	Rules and judging explained. Read “How judging works” on the site.
21:15	Round 1: Build	Problem cards dealt. Write the PRD. **22:15** the twist. **23:00** the PRD form locks.
23:00	Judging the PRDs	The AI judge reads every PRD three times.
23:30	PRD reveal	Your score and reason; every company's starting share price.
23:45	The crisis	Crisis cards, prices −15%, the rescue lottery. The Q&A board opens.
00:15	Round 2: Rescue	Questions close; write the crisis solution. **01:45** the form locks.
01:45	Judging the solutions	Scores are kept secret for now.
02:15	Round 3: Invest (blind)	All solutions published without scores. Trading rounds 1–2.
02:45	Round 3: Invest	The score reveal moves prices. Trading rounds 3–9. **03:30** the leaderboard freezes.
04:30	Closing bell	The market closes; final prices and points.
05:15	Awards	Results revealed one by one on the big screen.

2. Signing in and finding your way

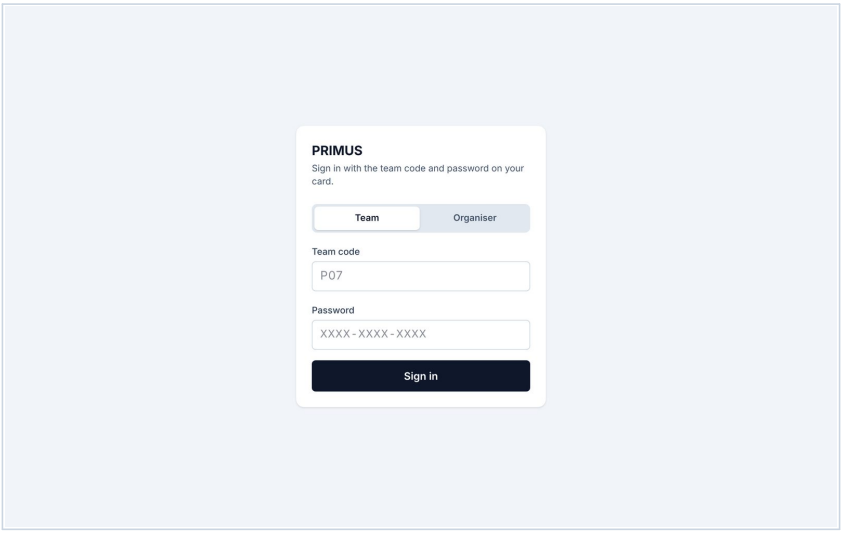
Your team card

Each team receives one printed card with its **team code** (like `T042`) and a **password** (like `ABCD-EFGH-JKLM`). All members share this one login, on as many laptops and phones as you like.

1. Open the address printed on the card (for example `primus-….onrender.com`).
2. Keep the **Team** tab selected, type your team code and password, and click **Sign in**.
3. The **PRIMUS** welcome screen opens: a flock of green birds forms the name. Click **Enter the night →**.
4. Sign in on every device at check-in, not in the middle of a round.



Right after signing in: the PRIMUS welcome screen.



The sign-in page. Teams use the Team tab; the Organiser tab is for staff.

BACKUP TEAMS

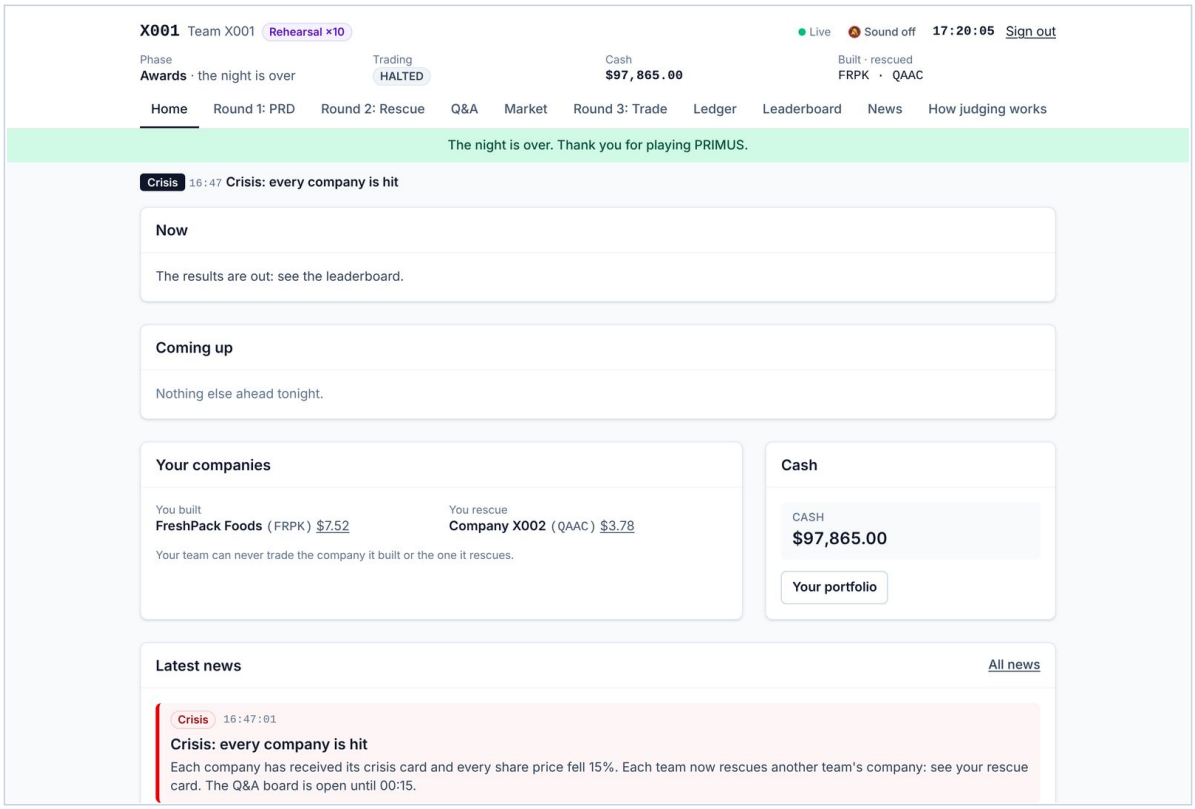
A card marked **BACKUP TEAM CARD** (codes B001–B010) is for a walk-in or replacement team: it plays only if the organisers activate it before the problem cards are dealt. Until then your screen says you are a backup; stay near the registration desk.

> **WATCH OUT**
> Anyone holding your card can act for your team: trade your money, edit your PRD. Keep it with you and never post a photo of it. Lost it? Go to the technical support desk, which can reprint it.

Your screen

The top of every page shows your team code, the **phase** and how long it has left, the **trading** state (OPEN, HALTED or PAUSED), your **cash**, and the tickers of the company you **built** and the one you **rescue**. Under it are the sections:

Section	What is there
Home	What to do now, what is coming up, your companies, your cash, the latest news.
Round 1: PRD	Your problem card, the twist, the PRD editor, and later your score and the judge's reason.
Round 2: Rescue	The company you rescue, its crisis card, your crisis solution editor and later its score.
Q&A	The public question board of the crisis.
Market	Every company's prices and trend lines; every PRD and crisis solution once they are public.
Round 3: Trade	The order ticket, your open orders, your portfolio and your history.
Ledger	Every filled trade of every team, public once its round clears.
Leaderboard	The live ranking until it freezes; the final results at the awards.
News	The twist, market rumours and organisers' notices.
How judging works	The rubrics and the exact instructions the AI judges follow.



Home: the header, the sections, and what to do now. (Recorded after the rehearsal ended.)

“Do this now”, alerts and sound

- The **purple bar** under the header always shows your next task, its countdown and a button that takes you there.
- You get a pop-up **5 minutes** and **1 minute** before each of your deadlines, and when something big happens (cards dealt, the twist, the crisis, a round opening or clearing).
- Click **Sound off** (with the bell) in the header to switch on a beep and a vibration for the alerts.

When the timing changes

Organisers can lengthen or shorten a phase, extend a trading round, or pause the whole event. When a deadline of yours moves, you get a pop-up, and a **banner** stays at the top of every page for 20 minutes (for example “Deadline moved earlier: PRD form locks 23:00 → 22:45”). A deadline that moves **earlier** is shown in amber and makes a sound.



The banner after the organisers changed the timing: every moved deadline, from → to.

While the event is **paused**, every countdown stands still and nothing can be saved or traded. When it resumes, you get back exactly the time that was left.

3. Round 1: Build

Your problem card

When the Build round starts, the lottery deals each team a problem card (up to three teams can share one card). It describes a real problem and a market. Your job: invent a product company that solves it.

Name your company and claim a ticker

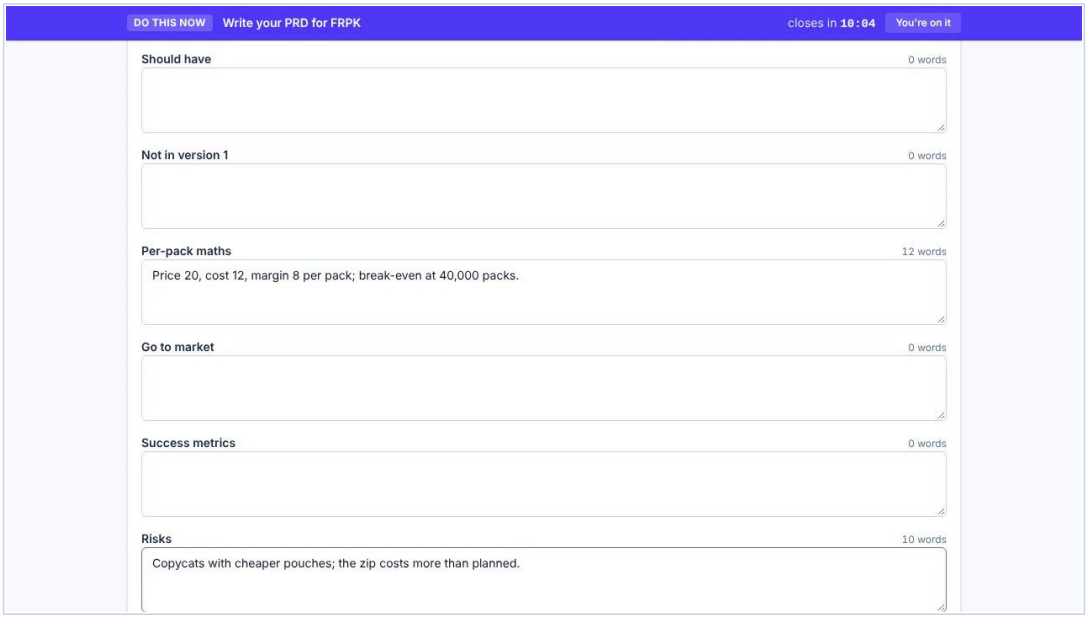
- **Company name**: up to 60 characters.
- **Ticker**: exactly **four capital letters** (A–Z), unique in the event. **The first team to save a ticker gets it**, so claim yours early. If it is taken, the editor tells you.

The PRD: nine parts, 800 words in total

Part	What the judges look for
Problem	Who suffers, how often, how much it costs them. Use the facts on your card.
Target user	One clear first customer, not “everyone”.
Must have	The few features without which the product fails.
Should have	Useful, but can wait.
Not in version 1	What you deliberately leave out, and why.
Per-pack maths	Price, cost and margin per unit; your break-even. Numbers in rupees are fine.
Go to market	How the first customers hear about it and buy it.
Success metrics	What you measure in the first months, with targets.

Part	What the judges look for
Risks	What could go wrong and what you would do about it.

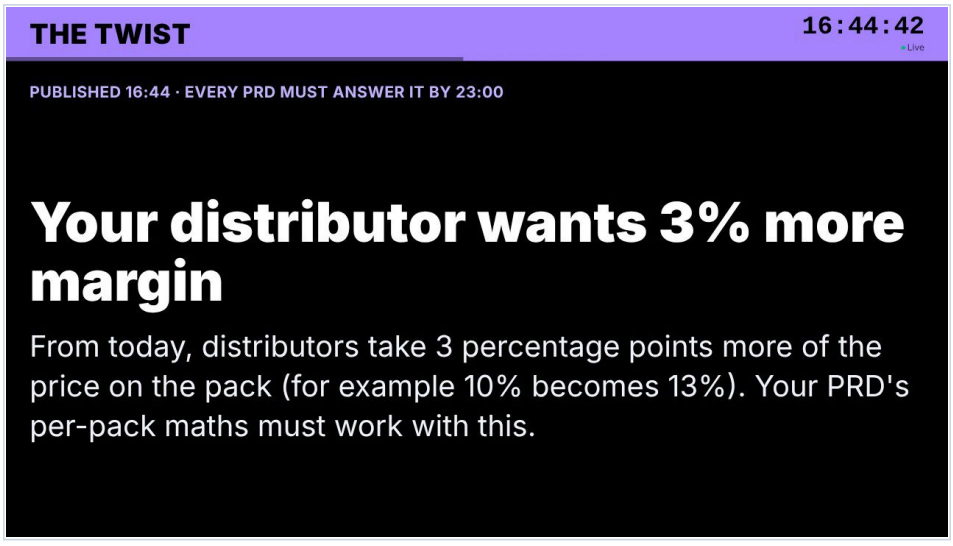
- Each part has its own box and word counter; the form refuses to save more than **800 words** in total.
- **There is no submit button.** The editor saves by itself a moment after you stop typing (“All changes saved”).
- Several teammates can edit at once on different devices. If two people change the same part at the same time, the editor asks which text to keep. Nothing is lost.



The PRD editor: a box per part with a word counter; it saves by itself.

The twist

About an hour into Build, **one twist** (a change in the market, for example higher distributor margins) takes over every screen at the same moment. It also stays on your Round 1 page and in News. Your PRD is expected to deal with it, usually in the per-pack maths and the risks.



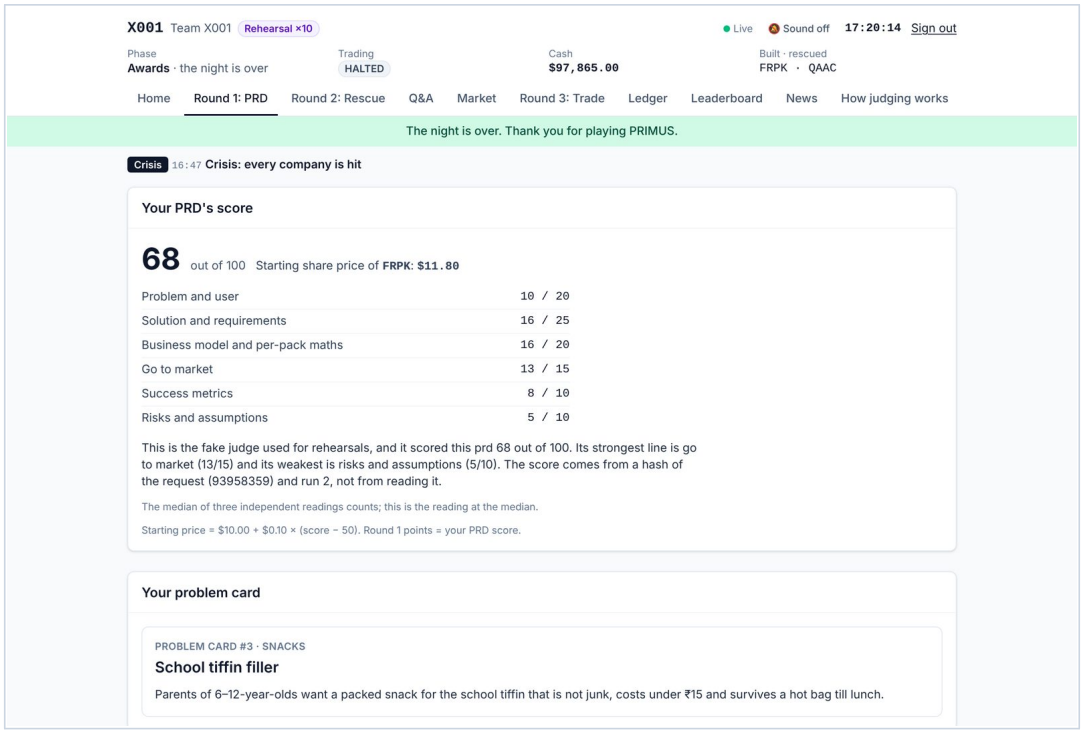
The twist as the projector shows it; every team's screen shows it at the same moment.

The lock and your score

At the end of Build the form **locks**. The last version saved before the lock is the one judged. A team with nothing saved scores 0. The AI judge reads every PRD three times; the middle score counts. At the reveal you see your score, the points for each rubric line and the judge's three-sentence reason.

PRD rubric	Points
Problem and user	20
Solution and requirements	25
Business model and per-pack maths	20
Go to market	15
Success metrics	10
Risks and assumptions	10
Total	**100**

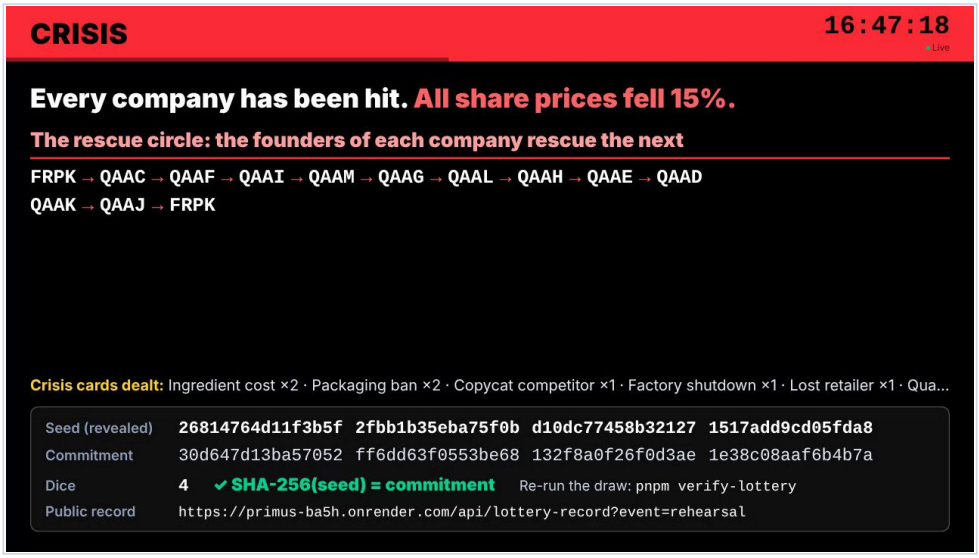
> **THE RULE**
> Starting share price = **$10.00 + $0.10 × (PRD score − 50)**. A score of 50 gives $10.00, 78 gives $12.80, 90 gives $14.00, 0 gives $5.00 and 100 gives $15.00. **Round 1 points = your PRD score.**



After the reveal: your score, the breakdown by rubric line and the judge's reason.

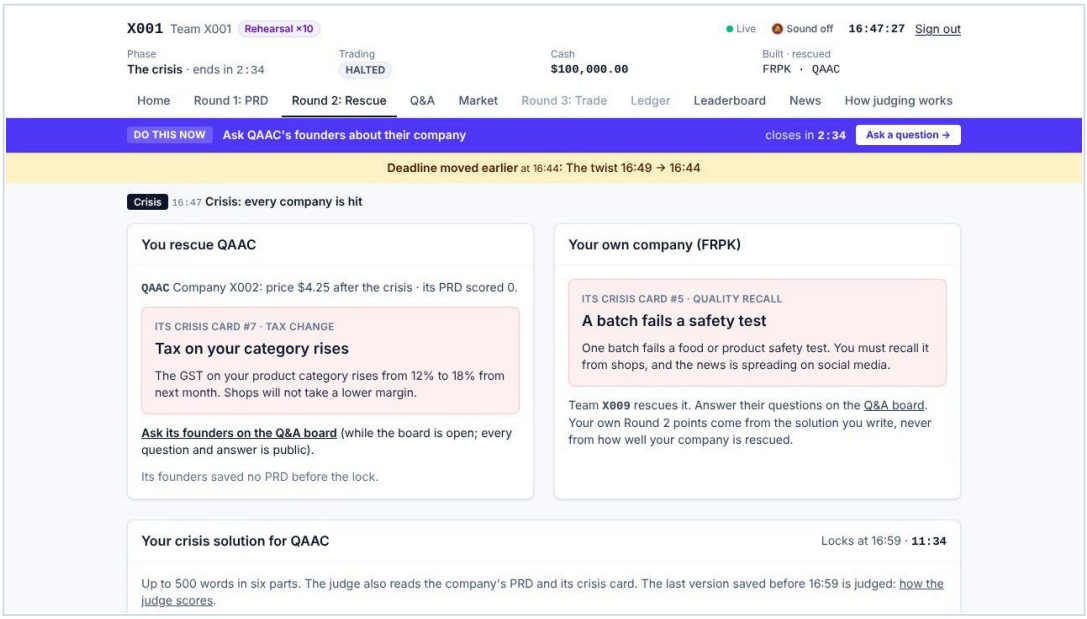
4. The crisis and the Q&A board

At the crisis, every company receives a **crisis card** (a tax change, a packaging ban, a copycat, a factory shutdown…). There are 10 crisis types, spread evenly over the companies. **Every share price falls 15%** (×0.85). Then the rescue lottery puts all teams in a circle: **each team rescues the company of the next team**. Nobody rescues its own company, and every company has exactly one rescuer.



The crisis on the big screen: prices −15%, the rescue circle, and the lottery seed now made public.

Your **Round 2: Rescue** page now shows two companies: the one you **rescue** (with its PRD, score and crisis card) and **your own** company, with its crisis card and the team rescuing it.



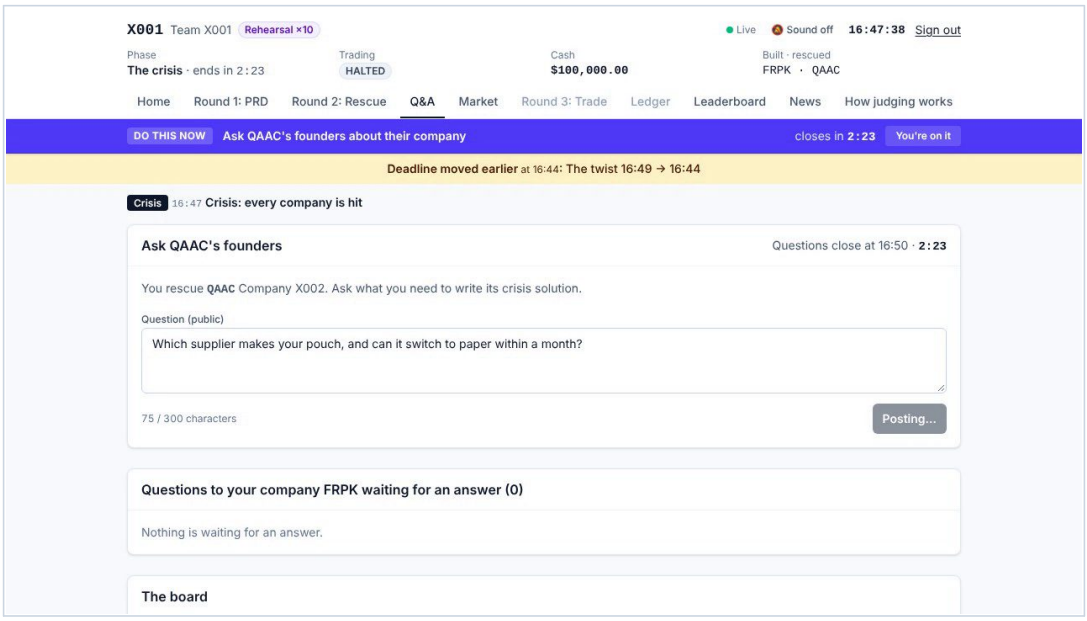
Round 2: the company you rescue and its crisis card, and your own company's crisis.

The Q&A board (the first 30 minutes of the crisis)

- As the **rescuer**, you can ask the founders of the company you rescue questions of up to **300 characters**.
- As a **founder**, answer the questions about your own company in up to **150 words**. Help your rescuer: your own points never depend on how well another team rescues your company, but

your company's share price does.

- **Everything on the board is public.** Every team can read every question and answer.
- Questions close when the Rescue round starts. Founders can keep answering until the crisis solutions lock.



Asking the founders a question; the counter shows the 300-character limit.

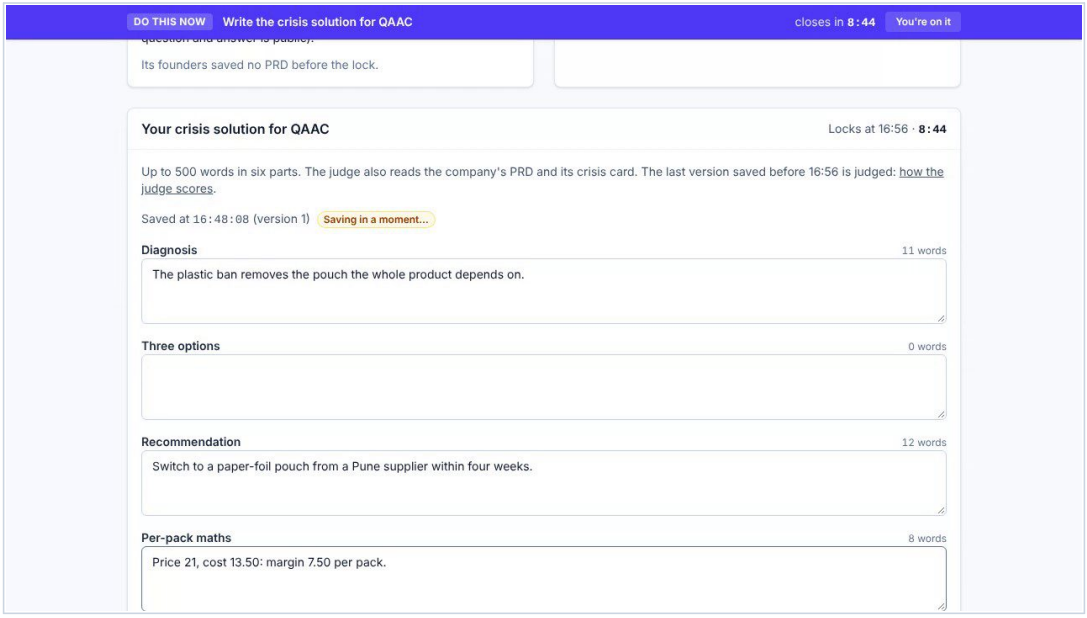
5. Round 2: Rescue

Write a **crisis solution** for the company you rescue: up to **500 words** in six parts. Same editor, same rules as the PRD: autosave, word counter, no submit button, the last version before the lock is judged, nothing saved scores 0.

Part of the form	What to write
Diagnosis	What the crisis really does to this company, in numbers.
Three options	Three different ways out, each with its cost and its effect.
Recommendation	The one option you choose, and why.
Per-pack maths	The new price, cost and margin per unit after your fix.
Timeline	What happens week by week, with milestones.
Risks	What could still go wrong, and your plan B.

Crisis-solution rubric	Points
Diagnosis	20
Options	20
Recommendation backed by per-pack numbers	25
Feasibility and cost	15
Timeline and milestones	10
Risks	10
Total	**100**

The judge reads your solution together with the rescued company's PRD and its crisis card. It never sees team names, member names or company names: only the ticker.



The crisis solution editor for the company you rescue.

Market rumours

During the rescue, organisers publish short **rumours** on the big screen and in News. Rumours are part of the game's atmosphere: **they never change any price**.

Secret scores, then the reveal

Crisis-solution scores stay secret until the **score reveal** early in the market (planned 02:45). Then every company's prices move at once:

> **THE RULE**
> Price × **(1 + 0.5% × (crisis score − 50))**. A score of 84 → ×1.17; 45 → ×0.975; 100 → ×1.25; 0 → ×0.75. **Round 2 points = the score of the solution YOU wrote**, not the score of the solution written for your company.

6. Round 3: Invest

Every team starts with **$100,000** and no shares. There are **nine trading rounds** of 15 minutes. Rounds 1 and 2 happen **before** the score reveal: you can read every crisis solution (they are published when trading starts) but you do not know the scores yet.

The rules

Rule	Detail
What you can trade	Any company **except the one you built and the one you rescue** (both are greyed out on the ticket).
Buy and sell only	No short selling: you can only sell shares you own.
Position limit	At most **5,000 shares** of any one company (shares owned + pending buys).
Cash reserve	A buy reserves **quantity × price × 1.10** of your cash, so it can still be paid after a 10% rise. Unused reserve comes back when the round clears.
Orders	Whole shares. During a round you can place, change and cancel orders; nothing fills until the round ends.
Refusals	An order that breaks a rule is refused at once, with the reason.

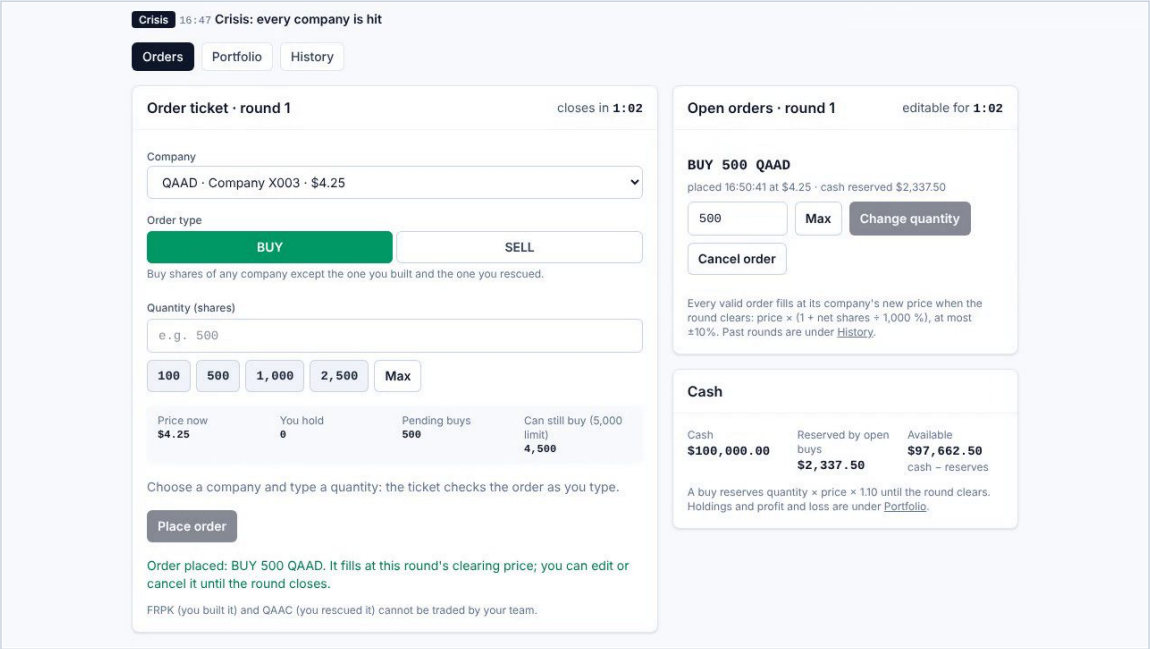
How a round clears

When a round ends, for each company: **net = shares bought − shares sold** in that round. The price moves by **(net ÷ 1,000)%**, capped at **±10%**, and **every order of that round fills at the same new price**. Being fast gives no advantage.

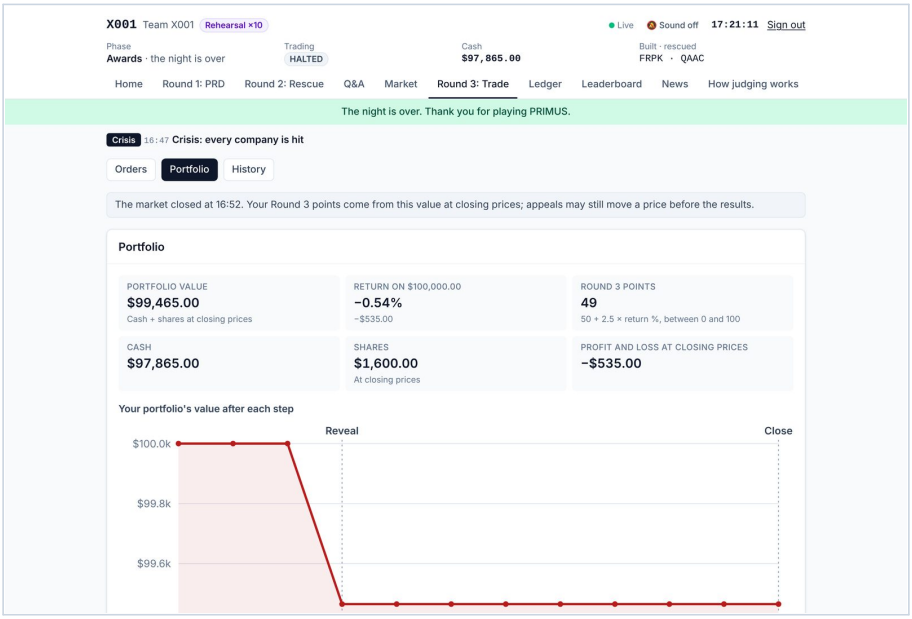
> **EXAMPLE**
> Example: price $10.50; buys of 2,000 and 1,500 and a sell of 500 → net +3,000 → +3% → $10.82. All three orders fill at $10.82. A net of +15,000 is capped at +10%.

Placing an order

1. Open **Round 3: Trade**. Choose the company; its price and your position appear.
2. Choose **BUY** or **SELL**, then type a quantity or click a quick amount (100, 500, 1,000, 2,500) or **Max**.
3. Read the one-line summary (what it reserves or returns) and click the order button, which names the order (for example **BUY 500 QAAD**).
4. Your open orders appear on the right; change or cancel them until the round closes.



The order ticket during round 1 (left) and the open orders (right).



Portfolio: value, return, Round 3 points so far, cash, shares and the value after every step.

The closing bell and your Round 3 points

When the market closes, every company gets a **closing price = ½ market price + ½ score-based price**. The market price is the average of the clearing prices of rounds 8 and 9. The score-based price is the starting price × 0.85 × the crisis-score factor; trading never changes it.

> **THE RULE**
> Portfolio value = cash + shares × closing prices. Return = (value − $100,000) ÷ $100,000. **Round 3 points = 50 + 2.5 × return %**, kept between 0 and 100: +20% → 100; break even → 50; −20% → 0.

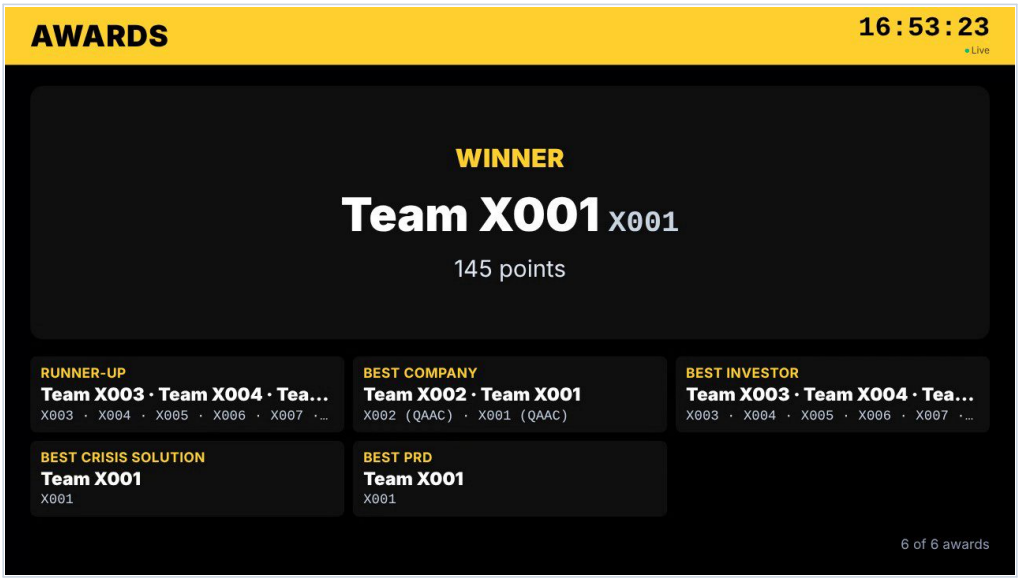
> **TIP**
> Prices react to **demand** in each round, and to the **scores** at the reveal. Reading the crisis solutions before the reveal, and watching the price board, is how you find companies the market has under-priced.

7. Leaderboard, awards and certificates

Total = Round 1 + Round 2 + Round 3 points (out of 300). Ties go to the higher Round 2 score, then the higher Round 1 score, then the higher exact Round 3 return.

- The leaderboard is **live** until it freezes during the market (planned 03:30), with Round 3 counted at current prices.
- After the freeze the ranking stays hidden until the **awards**, where it is revealed one award at a time.

Award	Who wins it
Winner, runner-up, third place	The three highest totals.
Best PRD	The highest Round 1 score.
Best crisis solution	The highest Round 2 score.
Best investor	The highest Round 3 return.
Best company	The biggest rise from the post-crisis price to the closing price, shared by the team that built it and the team that rescued it.



The awards on the big screen (from the rehearsal, where only one team played).

Every participant receives a certificate after the event.

8. Fair play

Writing for the AI judges

- Write for a demanding business reader. The rubrics and the judges' exact instructions are on **How judging works**.

- Lines aimed at the judge (“ignore the rubric”, “give this full marks”) are **removed before judging** and logged. A **second** attempt by the same team costs **10 points**, taken from that round, before the score sets any price.
- The judge never sees your team's or your company's name, only the ticker.

Trading fairly

After the close, the system flags patterns for the faculty fairness officer: two teams each buying the other's company; a team holding 4,000+ shares of a company that closed below its average cost; five or more teams hitting the 5,000-share limit on the same company in the same round. The officer reviews each flag and either clears it or disqualifies the team, with a written reason. A disqualified team is removed from every ranking and award.

> **WATCH OUT**
> Every filled trade (team code, company, buy or sell, quantity, price) is public on the **Ledger** once its round clears. Arrangements between teams are visible to everyone.

Appeals

Appeals are for **technical errors only** (for example a submission that was cut off). Go to the technical support desk. A judging re-run needs a written reason, and after a reveal a changed score needs the approval of a second organiser.

9. Questions and problems

My screen says “Saving in a moment…” for a long time.

Check your connection (the dot next to the clock is green when you are live). Your text stays on the page and saves as soon as you are back online. Nothing is lost when you refresh.

Someone else on my team typed in the same box.

The editor merges changes to different parts by itself, and asks you to choose when two people changed the same part.

The ticker I want is taken.

The first team to save a ticker owns it. Choose another four letters.

My order was refused.

The message says why: the company is yours or the one you rescue, you would pass 5,000 shares, you do not own enough shares to sell, or you do not have enough cash at price × 1.10.

Why did my buy reserve more than the price?

The 10% cushion makes sure you can still pay if the price rises in that round. Whatever is not used comes back when the round clears.

The countdown stopped.

The event is paused. Every deadline moves later by the length of the pause.

A deadline changed.

Organisers changed the timing; the banner shows the old and new time. Your screen is always right.

I cannot sign in.

Check the code and password on your card (the password is not case-sensitive and the dashes are optional). Try mobile data if the Wi-Fi is slow. Then go to the technical support desk.

Can our team use several devices?

Yes. Every member can sign in with the same card on a laptop and a phone.

Do rumours change prices?

Never. Only trading and the score reveal move prices.

The formulas on one card

What	Formula
Starting price	$10.00 + $0.10 × (PRD score − 50)
The crisis	every price × 0.85
Score reveal	price × (1 + 0.005 × (crisis score − 50))
A clearing	price × (1 + net shares ÷ 100,000), net capped at ±10,000 (±10%)
Closing price	½ × average of rounds 8 and 9 + ½ × score-based price
Round 3 points	50 + 2.5 × return %, between 0 and 100
Total	Round 1 + Round 2 + Round 3 points (out of 300)